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After Liang Shi spoke, she realized she had misspoken. Her expression turned awkward.

Lu Jiayi, however, showed no reaction. Even though she could tell Liang Shi was deliberately being confrontational, she still smiled faintly. "Hard to say."

Because they weren't close, it was hard to say whether not seeing each other for a long time was good or bad.

She deflected the sharpness in Liang Shi's words.

For a moment, it made Liang Shi seem somewhat petty.

Liang Shi had always been rather smooth when it came to dealing with people, yet she didn't know why she harbored such hostility toward Lu Jiayi.

Looking at her just made her feel annoyed.

Actually, thinking about it carefully, Lu Jiayi hadn't done anything to make her dislike her.

It was just that in her mind, there was a "conceptual Lu Jiayi"—a fictional image that had already been colored by subjective impressions before she had even met the real Lu Jiayi.

It was rather unfair to Lu Jiayi.

Liang Shi seemed to be condemning her for things that hadn't happened, which was biased.

After thinking this, Liang Shi felt even more embarrassed. But then she thought again—she and Lu Jiayi were never meant to be the kind of people who could sit down together for a friendly cup of coffee. It was best to remain strangers.

Liang Shi's thoughts changed several times within a few minutes.

Before she could fully sort things out, Lu Jiayi suddenly asked, "Have you eaten?"

Liang Shi frowned. "Breakfast or lunch?"

Lu Jiayi chuckled softly at this. "Lunch."

"Not yet," Liang Shi said. "Why?"

"I'd like to treat you to a meal. Are you free?" Lu Jiayi paused after saying this, then added, "My business partner's wife."

Liang Shi: "..."